

Week 5 at a Glance

Wednesday–Saturday, October 7 – 10, 2026 · about two hours each morning · AO Year 2 Term 1 week 5

EVERY SCHOOL DAY

- Outdoor sit or walk, 20 min (heat-wise)
- Bible, 10–15 min, then narrate (Fri lighter — Exodus done)
- Hymn or folk song, 5 min
- Ray’s New Practical Arithmetic, next lesson (9–12), 15–20 min
- Copywork, one line, 10 min
- Recitation, 5 min
- One main reading + narration
- One lighter reading or riches

HOLD ALL WEEK

Copywork: I heard a horseman / Ride over the hill;

Recitation: Genesis 1:1 ESV — from their physical Bible; do not print the verse wording here.

Hymn: first stanza of “I Bind Unto Myself Today”

Folk song: “The Bold Grenadier” — preview lyrics

Math: Ray’s Lessons 9–12. One lesson each school day. Oral first. Do not dump the book.

DAY	BIBLE	MAIN READING	RICHES / EXTRA
Wed 7	Exodus 13 + Awana	Trial and Triumph · Alfred (your copy)	Ray’s L9 · copywork · hymn · The Horseman
Thu 8	Exodus 14 + Awana	Little Duke, ch. 3 first half	Harvey’s · Tree in the Trail ch. 3 · folk
Fri 9	— (Exodus finished)	Burgess Animal Book ch. 5	WITW finish Badger · Grimm · Ray’s L11 · picture study
Sat 10	Luke 20:9–18	Understood Betsy ch. 4	Harvey’s · Pilgrim’s Progress · evening walk

Books to have open

- ESV Bible (physical copy — passages by reference only; no verse text printed)
- Ray’s New Practical Arithmetic (Mott) — Lessons 9–12
- Harvey’s Elementary Grammar (Mott) — two short sittings
- Trial and Triumph* — Alfred the Great from **your copy** (not printed)
- The Little Duke*, ch. 3 first half (printed)
- Tree in the Trail* — ch. 3 from **your copy** (not printed; still catching up — not AO’s later chapters)
- Grimm’s Pantheon — one gentle tale by title (not printed)
- The Wind in the Willows*, finish Mr. Badger morning (printed; cap 20)
- Burgess Animal Book*, ch. 5 · *Understood Betsy*, ch. 4

Two children

The 2nd grader does the whole morning. The preschooler joins Bible, songs, poems, animal stories, picture study, Grimm, and outside. During math, copywork, and heavier history they play nearby — McGuffey picture-pages are fine.

Heat

Bastrop early October. Outside at 8am or after 6pm. Not midday. Times slide; keep the order.

This week’s shifts

No Island Story this week (ch. 26 waits for Week 6). No second CHOW Vikings/Leif sitting — Week 4 already covered that ground. *Trial and Triumph* Alfred carries the history weight from your copy. Geography stays *Tree in the Trail* catch-up ch. 3. No Cooper chapter assignment.

Free sources

Books on the shelf (and what waits)

You already own several that older plans still listed as “buy.” This page is the truth for the house. Do not reprint copyrighted books.

YOU OWN THESE · USE FROM THE PHYSICAL COPY

Tree in the Trail (Holling) — catch-up this week: ch. 3 (~15–20 min). Still catching up — do **not** jump to AO’s later Trail chapters (not ch. 7). Never reprint.

Trial and Triumph (Hannula) — **Alfred the Great this week**, from your copy only. Intensity preview: some martyr and battle pages are hard for Form IB — read ahead; shorten or soft-narrate a harsh line if needed. Never reprint.

Seabird (Holling) — owned. Hold until AO around Week 19. Shelf only until then.

SHELF WEAVE THIS WEEK · DO NOT STACK A SECOND SCHOOL DAY

- **Ray’s New Practical Arithmetic** (Mott) — Lessons 9–12; one lesson each school day; oral first.
- **Harvey’s Elementary Grammar** (Mott) — two ~10 min sittings (Thu + Sat).
- **Grimm’s Pantheon** — one short gentle tale by title (e.g. “The Golden Goose,” “Mother Holle,” or “The Queen Bee”). Open their Pantheon. Never reprint.
- **The Wind in the Willows** — finish the Mr. Badger morning sitting (printed; still cap 20). Bookmark if unfinished.
- **McGuffey Pictorial Primer** (Mott) — preschooler informal picture-page during copywork/math.
- **Awana workbook** — Wed + Thu only, 10–15 min AFTER Bible, next page in their physical book. Never reprint.

BUY-AHEAD / LATER THIS YEAR

Nothing new to buy this month. Tree in the Trail, Trial and Triumph, and Seabird are already owned — no buy flag. Diane Stanley’s *Joan of Arc* still around Week 25 — too far for a buy box. Library is fine for any picture-study or composer listening.

No Cooper chapter this week. CM habits live on the teaching-guide pages instead.

How to sit with them this week

Short lessons. One reading. Narration. Atmosphere. No teacher-book chapter to finish.

01 Narration is the lesson

Read once. Close the book. Let the child tell it back. Do not interrupt. Do not prompt with “and then what?” A few true sentences are enough. Thank them. Do not grade it.

02 Short lessons

Fifteen to twenty minutes. Stop while they still want more. Ray’s is one lesson. Alfred is one sitting from your copy. Do not mash history with Little Duke the same hour.

03 One reading

One careful reading is the gift. Re-reading to “make sure they got it” trains them not to attend the first time. Trust the narration.

04 Wait

After you close the book, wait a full ten seconds before you speak. Silence is not failure. It is the mind at work.

05 Atmosphere

The room teaches. Calm voice, ordered table, no hurry-shame. If the morning frays, a song and a walk still count as school. Pick up tomorrow.

06 Two children

Preschooler joins living stories, songs, poems, Burgess, Grimm, picture study, nature. Not expected to narrate Alfred. Quiet work (or McGuffey pictures) through math and copywork.

07 Shelf books stay light

Ray’s, Harvey’s, Awana, Grimm, TITT, and Trial and Triumph are woven into the same morning — not a second school day. Awana only Wed and Thu, after Bible.

08 If you only do one thing

Read once. Wait. Let them narrate. That is the whole method in three moves.

How to teach this week

Alfred from your copy. Little Duke printed. No Island Story. No second Vikings chapter.

01 Bible without a sermon

Wednesday: Exodus 13 — consecration of the firstborn, unleavened bread, leaving Egypt remembered.

Thursday: Exodus 14 — the Red Sea. Both may run long; one reading, narrate the main thread, stop if the clock wins. Saturday: Luke 20:9–18, the Parable of the Tenants. Friday: no third Exodus — the week's OT is done. Open the ESV; never print verse text.

02 Awana, Wed and Thu only

Ten to fifteen minutes AFTER Bible. Next page in their physical Awana book. Never reprint Awana. Fri and Sat: no Awana.

03 Ray's Lessons 9–12

Continue after Week 4's Lessons 5–8. One lesson each school day. Oral first when the book allows. Do not dump pages. Preschooler: quiet work or McGuffey pictures nearby.

04 Copywork and recitation

New line from de la Mare's "The Horseman": *I heard a horseman / Ride over the hill*; Best handwriting. Then stop. Recitation stays Genesis 1:1 from their ESV — reference only in this packet.

05 Trial and Triumph · Alfred

From **your copy** only — never reprint Hannula. One sitting Wednesday. Preview first; intensity note: soften or skip a harsh martyr/battle page if needed. Narrate who Alfred was and one true thing he did. This carries the week's history weight (no Island Story; no repeat CHOW Vikings).

06 No Island Story · no second CHOW

Island Story ch. 26 (William's death) waits for Week 6. Week 4 already printed Hillyer "End of the World" (Vikings/Leif). Do not reprint or reassign that chapter. Alfred is enough history this week.

07 Little Duke, ch. 3 first half

Burial of Duke William, the investiture and homage at Rouen, young Richard's long ceremony. Printed sitting. Cap ~20 min. Narrate the crowning/homage and how tired the little duke became.

08 Tree in the Trail, ch. 3

From **your copy**. One sitting Thursday, ~15–20 min. Still catching up from Weeks 3–4 — do **not** jump to AO's later chapters. Never reprint TITT.

09 Harvey's, twice

Two ~10-minute sittings (Thu and Sat). Oral and light. Do not dump the book.

10 Grimm by title only

Open their Pantheon. One short gentle tale — "The Golden Goose," "Mother Holle," or "The Queen Bee." Not a gruesome first tale. Never reprint.

11 Wind in the Willows

Week 4 left Mole and Rat in Badger's clean lavender beds. This week: breakfast, hedgehogs, Otter, Badger's kindness — printed sitting. **Cap 20 minutes.** Bookmark if unfinished.

12 What you are not doing

No Cooper chapter. No Island Story. No Seabird until ~Week 19. No Parables from Nature. No AO jump on Tree in the Trail past catch-up. No reprint of Trial and Triumph.

How to teach this week

Burgess, Betsy, Pilgrim's Progress, October riches.

13 Burgess ch. 5

"The Squirrels of the Trees." Both children. Narrate one true thing about a tree squirrel. No classification chart. Ch. 6 only if the same sitting still has delight and time — prefer one chapter. Gutenberg 2441.

14 Understood Betsy ch. 4

"Betsy Goes to School." Cap at 20 minutes even if unfinished. Narrate what school is like for Elizabeth Ann now. Gutenberg 5347.

15 Pilgrim's Progress, Help and the road

After Week 4's fall into the Slough: Help draws Christian out, the dreamer asks why the Slough stays miry, Pliable's neighbors talk, and Mr. Worldly Wiseman begins to speak. ~700 words printed. Stop where the packet stops.

16 Poetry: "The Horseman"

Walter de la Mare, *Peacock Pie*. Not Tired Tim, Some One, the cupboard, or the moon line. Read once. Both children. Copywork from the opening.

17 Term 1 riches, still brief

Hymn: first stanza of St. Patrick's Breastplate / "I Bind Unto Myself Today." Folk: Bold Grenadier (clean verses). Picture study: Rockwell *Freedom of Speech* — brief if wanted; you have looked several weeks. Composer: Bernstein *Jeremiah*, five to eight minutes — no copyrighted body text in the packet.

18 Nature

Lost Pines / early October. Pines, lingering heat, cicadas fading, insects, creek edges, birds. Morning sit or Saturday evening walk. Watch for fire ants. Nature notebook: draw, date, scribe one sentence.

19 If it falls apart

Skip to outdoor time. Keep Bible (when scheduled), Ray's, and that day's main reading. Riches can wait. A song and a walk still count.

20 Owned shelf, again

TITT ch. 3 and Trial and Triumph Alfred are from the house copies this week. Seabird waits for ~Week 19. Never reprint those three.

Wednesday

HAVE READY

Bible · Awana workbook · hymn words · Ray's (Lesson 9) · copywork line · *Trial and Triumph* (Alfred, your copy) · "The Horseman" · nature notebook · McGuffey nearby

8:00 **Nature sit** PRESCHOOLER JOINS

Backyard or porch. Twenty minutes. One thing only — pine needle, fading cicada song, bird call. Look. Sketch if they want. Heat-wise — shade is fine.

8:25 **Bible · Exodus 13**

Open your ESV to Exodus 13. Read once. Close the Bible. Narrate. Then stop.

8:40 **Awana** AFTER BIBLE

Ten to fifteen minutes. Next page in their physical Awana book. Never reprint.

8:55 **Hymn** PRESCHOOLER JOINS

First stanza of "I Bind Unto Myself Today." Sing. Do not explain it to death.

9:05 **Ray's · Lesson 9**

Next lesson after Week 4's Lesson 8. Oral first. One lesson. Preschooler: McGuffey picture-page or quiet work.

9:25 **Copywork + recitation**

Copywork: *I heard a horseman / Ride over the hill*; Recitation: Genesis 1:1 from their ESV (no printed wording).

9:40 **History · Trial and Triumph · Alfred**

From **your copy** — Alfred the Great. Cap ~15–20 min. Preview intensity; soften if needed. Narrate. **Stop.** No Island Story today (Week 6). No CHOW reprint.

10:10 **Poem · "The Horseman"**

Read once. Both children. No talk after unless they start it.

How to teach Wednesday

Alfred from your copy only. Never reprint Hannula. No Island Story. No second Vikings/CHOW sitting.

Bible and Awana

Exodus 13 is enough. One reading. Narration. Awana after Bible — physical book only, next page, then put it away.

Ray's Lesson 9

Continue the Mott Ray's from where Week 4 left off. Oral first. Stop after one lesson even if they are eager.

Alfred

This is the week's history weight. Read ahead. If a page is too hard, soft-narrate or skip that page and keep the thread of Alfred as king who loved learning and defended his people.

Poem

"The Horseman" is the week's poem and the copywork well. Read for delight — not Tired Tim again.

Preschooler: nature, Bible as they will sit, hymn, poem. Quiet work / McGuffey through Ray's and copywork. They may listen to Alfred if still; they need not narrate it.

Bible · Exodus 13

ESV · open your physical copy · never reprint verse text

Open your ESV to Exodus 13.

Read once. Close the Bible. Narrate. Then stop.

Do not print or paste ESV (or any modern) Bible text — use the physical book only.

Consecration of the firstborn; unleavened bread; remembering the departure.

Trial and Triumph · Alfred the Great

From your physical book · never reprinted in this packet

Open your copy of *Trial and Triumph* to Alfred the Great.

One sitting. Read once (or soft-narrate a hard page). Close the book. Narrate. Then stop.

Intensity preview: some trials are hard for Form IB. You may shorten or skip a harsh line. Never reprint this book in a packet.

This carries history this week — no Island Story (Week 6) and no repeat of last week's CHOW Vikings sitting.

The Horseman

Walter de la Mare, Peacock Pie. Project Gutenberg eBook #3753. Public domain. Copywork well for the week.

I heard a horseman

Ride over the hill;

The moon shone clear,

The night was still;

His helm was silver,

And pale was he;

And the horse he rode

Was of ivory.

DAY TWO · BOTH CHILDREN AT 8:00

OCTOBER 8, 2026

Thursday

HAVE READY

Bible · Awana · folk song · Ray's (Lesson 10) · *The Little Duke* ch. 3 first half · Harvey's · *Tree in the Trail* (your copy, ch. 3) · McGuffey nearby

8:00 **Nature sit** PRESCHOOLER JOINS

Ten minutes if Wednesday's sit went well. Or skip and save the long walk for Saturday evening.

8:15 **Bible · Exodus 14**

Open your ESV to Exodus 14. The Red Sea. Longer chapter — one reading; narrate the main thread; stop if the clock wins.

8:35 **Awana** AFTER BIBLE

Ten to fifteen minutes. Next page. Physical book only. Last Awana day this week.

8:50 **Folk song** PRESCHOOLER JOINS

"The Bold Grenadier." Clean verses only. Sing; do not lecture.

9:00 **Ray's, copywork, recitation**

Lesson 10. Copywork line from "The Horseman." Genesis 1:1 from their ESV. Preschooler: McGuffey or quiet work.

9:30 **Tales · Little Duke, ch. 3 first half**

Printed sitting: burial, investiture, homage. Cap ~20 min. Narrate what happened to little Richard in the church.

9:55	Harvey’s · ~10 min Continue from Week 4’s place. Oral and light. Do not dump the book.
10:10	Geography · Tree in the Trail ch. 3 From your copy . ~15–20 min. Still catching up — do not jump ahead. Never reprint.

How to teach Thursday

TITT from your copy only. Do not reprint Holling. Do not jump past catch-up to AO's later Trail chapters.

Bible and Awana

Exodus 14 is the sea crossing — protect one reading and a clear narration. Awana after Bible; then put the workbook away until next Wednesday.

Little Duke

Chapter 3 opens with the burial and the long homage. First half only (printed). Second half waits.

Tree in the Trail

Ch. 3 catch-up. One living sitting. Prefer not to stack a second Trail chapter today.

Harvey's

Ten minutes. Continue. Stop while willing.

Preschooler: Bible as they will sit, folk song. Quiet work through Ray's, copywork, Little Duke, Harvey's. They may listen to TITT if still.

READ THIS · THURSDAY

Bible · Exodus 14

ESV · open your physical copy · never reprint verse text

Open your ESV to Exodus 14.

Read once. Close the Bible. Narrate. Then stop.

Do not print or paste ESV (or any modern) Bible text — use the physical book only.

The Red Sea. Longer chapter — one reading. Stop if the clock wins.

The Little Duke · Chapter 3 · first half

Charlotte M. Yonge. Project Gutenberg eBook #3048. Public domain. Continues after Week 4's close of chapter 2.

CHAPTER III

Duke William of the Long Sword was buried the next morning in high pomp and state, with many a prayer and psalm chanted over his grave.

When this was over, little Richard, who had all the time stood or knelt nearest the corpse, in one dull heavy dream of wonder and sorrow, was led back to the palace, and there his long, heavy, black garments were taken off, and he was dressed in his short scarlet tunic, his hair was carefully arranged, and then he came down again into the hall, where there was a great assembly of Barons, some in armour, some in long furred gowns, who had all been attending his father's burial. Richard, as he was desired by Sir Eric de Centeville, took off his cap, and bowed low in reply to the reverences with which they all greeted his entrance, and he then slowly crossed the hall, and descended the steps from the door, while they formed into a procession behind him, according to their ranks--the Duke of Brittany first, and then all the rest, down to the poorest knight who held his manor immediately from the Duke of Normandy.

Thus, they proceeded, in slow and solemn order, till they came to the church of our Lady. The clergy were there already, ranged in ranks on each side of the Choir; and the Bishops, in their mitres and rich robes, each with his pastoral staff in his hand, were standing round the Altar. As the little Duke entered, there arose from all the voices in the Chancel the full, loud, clear chant of *Te Deum Laudamus*, echoing among the dark vaults of the roof. To that sound, Richard walked up the Choir, to a large, heavy, crossed-legged, carved chair, raised on two steps, just before the steps of the Altar began, and there he stood, Bernard de Harcourt and Eric de Centeville on each side of him, and all his other vassals in due order, in the Choir.

After the beautiful chant of the hymn was ended, the service for the Holy Communion began. When the time came for the offering, each noble gave gold or silver; and, lastly, Rainulf of Ferrieres came up to the step of the Altar with a cushion, on which was placed a circlet of gold, the ducal coronet; and another Baron, following him closely, carried a long, heavy sword, with a cross handle. The Archbishop of Rouen received both coronet and sword, and laid them on the Altar. Then the service proceeded. At that time the rite of Confirmation was administered in infancy, and Richard, who had been confirmed by his godfather, the Archbishop of Rouen, immediately after his baptism, knelt in solemn awe to receive the other Holy Sacrament from his hands, as soon as all the clergy had communicated.

When the administration was over, Richard was led forward to the step of the Altar by Count Bernard, and Sir Eric, and the Archbishop, laying one hand upon both his, as he held them clasped together, demanded of him, in the name of God, and of the people of Normandy, whether he would be their good and true ruler, guard them from their foes, maintain truth, punish iniquity, and protect the Church.

"I will!" answered Richard's young, trembling voice, "So help me God!" and he knelt, and kissed the book of the Holy Gospels, which the Archbishop offered him.

It was a great and awful oath, and he dreaded to think that he had taken it. He still knelt, put both hands over his face, and whispered, "O God, my Father, help me to keep it."

The Archbishop waited till he rose, and then, turning him with his face to the people, said, "Richard, by the grace of God, I invest thee with the ducal mantle of Normandy!"

Two of the Bishops then hung round his shoulders a crimson velvet mantle, furred with ermine, which, made as it was for a grown man, hung heavily on the poor child's shoulders, and lay in heaps on the ground. The Archbishop then set the golden coronet on his long, flowing hair, where it hung so loosely on the little head, that Sir Eric was obliged to put his hand to it to hold it safe; and, lastly, the long, straight, two-handed sword was brought and placed

in his hand, with another solemn bidding to use it ever in maintaining the right. It should have been girded to his side, but the great sword was so much taller than the little Duke, that, as it stood upright by him, he was obliged to raise his arm to put it round the handle.

He then had to return to his throne, which was not done without some difficulty, encumbered as he was, but Osmond held up the train of his mantle, Sir Eric kept the coronet on his head, and he himself held fast and lovingly the sword, though the Count of Harcourt offered to carry it for him. He was lifted up to his throne, and then came the paying him homage; Alan, Duke of Brittany, was the first to kneel before him, and with his hand between those of the Duke, he swore to be his man, to obey him, and pay him feudal service for his dukedom of Brittany. In return, Richard swore to be his good Lord, and to protect him from all his foes. Then followed Bernard the Dane, and many another, each repeating the same formulary, as their large rugged hands were clasped within those little soft fingers. Many a kind and loving eye was bent in compassion on the orphan child; many a strong voice faltered with earnestness as it pronounced the vow, and many a brave, stalwart heart heaved with grief for the murdered father, and tears flowed down the war-worn cheeks which had met the fiercest storms of the northern ocean, as they bent before the young fatherless boy, whom they loved for the sake of his conquering grandfather, and his brave and pious father. Few Normans were there whose hearts did not glow at the touch of those small hands, with a love almost of a parent, for their young Duke.

The ceremony of receiving homage lasted long and Richard, though interested and touched at first, grew very weary; the crown and mantle were so heavy, the faces succeeded each other like figures in an endless dream, and the constant repetition of the same words was very tedious. He grew sleepy, he longed to jump up, to lean to the right or left, or to speak something besides that regular form. He gave one great yawn, but it brought him such a frown from the stern face of Bernard, as quite to wake him for a few minutes, and make him sit upright, and receive the next vassal with as much attention as he had shown the first, but he looked imploringly at Sir Eric, as if to ask if it ever would be over. At last, far down among the Barons, came one at whose sight Richard revived a little. It was a boy only a few years older than himself, perhaps about ten, with a pleasant brown face, black hair, and quick black eyes which glanced, with a look between friendliness and respect, up into the little Duke's gazing face. Richard listened eagerly for his name, and was refreshed at the sound of the boyish voice which pronounced, "I, Alberic de Montemar, am thy liegeman and vassal for my castle and barony of Montemar sur Epte."

When Alberic moved away, Richard followed him with his eye as far as he could to his place in the Cathedral, and was taken by surprise when he found the next Baron kneeling before him.

The ceremony of homage came to an end at last, and Richard would fain have run all the way to the palace to shake off his weariness, but he was obliged to head the procession again; and even when he reached the castle hall his toils were not over, for there was a great state banquet spread out, and he had to sit in the high chair where he remembered climbing on his father's knee last Christmas-day, all the time that the Barons feasted round, and held grave converse. Richard's best comfort all this time was in watching Osmond de Centeville and Alberic de Montemar, who, with the other youths who were not yet knighted, were waiting on those who sat at the table. At last he grew so very weary, that he fell fast asleep in the corner of his chair, and did not wake till he was startled by the rough voice of Bernard de Harcourt, calling him to rouse up, and bid the Duke of Brittany farewell.

"Poor child!" said Duke Alan, as Richard rose up, startled, "he is over-wearied with this day's work. Take care of him, Count Bernard; thou a kindly nurse, but a rough one for such a babe. Ha! my young Lord, your colour mantles at being called a babe! I crave your pardon, for you are a fine spirit. And hark you, Lord Richard of Normandy, I have little cause to love your race, and little right, I trow, had King Charles the Simple to call us free Bretons liegemen to a race of plundering Northern pirates. To Duke Rollo's might, my father never gave his homage; nay, nor did I yield it for all Duke William's long sword, but I did pay it to his generosity and forbearance, and now I grant it to thy weakness and to his noble memory. I doubt not that the recreant Frank, Louis, whom he restored to his throne, will strive to profit by thy youth and helplessness, and should that be, remember that thou hast no surer friend than Alan of Brittany. Fare thee well, my young Duke."

"Farewell, Sir," said Richard, willingly giving his hand to be shaken by his kind vassal, and watching him as Sir Eric attended him from the hall.

Stop here. First half of chapter 3. The rest of the chapter waits for a later week.

Tree in the Trail · Chapter 3

From your physical book · never reprinted in this packet

Open your copy of *Tree in the Trail* to chapter 3.

One sitting, about 15–20 minutes. Read once. Narrate. Then stop.

Still catching up (Week 3 ch. 1, Week 4 ch. 2). Do **not** jump to AO's later chapters. Never reprint Holling.

Harvey's Elementary Grammar · short sitting

From your physical book · never reprinted in this packet

Open your Mott Media Harvey's.

About ten minutes. Continue from last week's place. Oral and light. Do not dump the book.

Second Harvey's sitting waits for Saturday.

DAY THREE · BOTH CHILDREN AT 8:00

OCTOBER 9, 2026

Friday

HAVE READY

Hymn · Ray's (Lesson 11) · Burgess ch. 5 · Grimm Pantheon · Wind in the Willows · picture study (optional brief) · nature notebook

8:00 Nature sit PRESCHOOLER JOINS

Twenty minutes. Early-October Lost Pines: heat, insects, cicadas fading, a pine cone or bark change.

8:25 No third Exodus today

Exodus 13 and 14 are done. Begin with hymn. (Saturday holds Luke.) No Awana today.

8:30 Hymn, Ray's, copywork, recitation

Same stanza. Lesson 11. Copywork line. Genesis 1:1 from their ESV. Preschooler: McGuffey or quiet work through math and copywork.

9:05 Nature lore · Burgess ch. 5

"The Squirrels of the Trees." Printed. Both children. Narrate one squirrel true thing. Ch. 6 only if time and delight remain.

9:30 Wind in the Willows · finish Badger

Breakfast at Badger's — printed. **Cap 20 minutes.** Bookmark if unfinished.

9:55 Grimm · one gentle tale

From their Pantheon, by title only. Suggest "The Golden Goose," "Mother Holle," or "The Queen Bee." Never reprint.

10:10 Picture study (optional)

Rockwell *Freedom of Speech* — brief look if the morning still has calm; else skip. Do not print.

How to teach Friday

No Awana. No third Exodus. Protect Burgess narration and the Willows twenty-minute cap. Picture study only if calm remains.

Lighter Bible day

OT for the week is finished. Keep the morning's living books; Saturday holds the Gospel parable.

Burgess, then Willows

Animal lore first. Then Badger's morning — hedgehogs, Otter, kindness. Two narrations, not one mashed sitting.

Grimm

By title from the Pantheon. One gentle tale.

Picture study (optional)

Rockwell *Freedom of Speech* — brief if several weeks already felt enough. Look; do not print.

Preschooler: nature, Burgess, Grimm, Willows. Quiet through Ray's and copywork.

The Burgess Animal Book · Chapter 5 · The Squirrels of the Trees

Thornton W. Burgess. Project Gutenberg eBook #2441. Public domain.

CHAPTER V · THE SQUIRRELS OF THE TREES

Peter Rabbit found Johnny Chuck sitting on his doorstep, sunning himself. Peter was quite out of breath because he had hurried so. "Do you know that you are a Squirrel, Johnny Chuck?" he panted.

Johnny slowly turned his head and looked at Peter as if he thought Peter had suddenly gone crazy. "What are you talking about, Peter Rabbit? I'm not a Squirrel; I'm a Woodchuck," he replied.

"Just the same, you are a Squirrel," retorted Peter. "The Woodchucks belong to the Squirrel family. Old Mother Nature says so, and if she says so, it is so. You'd better join our school, Johnny Chuck, and learn a little about your own relatives."

Johnny Chuck blinked his eyes and for a minute or two couldn't find a word to say. He knew that if Peter were telling the truth as to what Old Mother Nature had said, it must be true that he was member of the Squirrel family. But it was hard to believe. "What is this school?" he finally asked.

Peter hastened to tell him. He told Johnny all about what he and Jumper the Hare had learned about their family, and all the surprising things Old Mother Nature had told them about the Squirrel family, and he ended by again urging Johnny Chuck to join the school and promised to call for Johnny the next morning.

But Johnny Chuck is lazy and does not like to go far from his own doorstep, so when Peter called the next morning Johnny refused to go, despite all Peter could say. Peter didn't waste much time arguing for he was afraid he would be late and miss something. When he reached the Green Forest he found his cousin, Jumper the Hare, and Chatterer the Red Squirrel, and Happy Jack the Gray Squirrel, already there. As soon as Peter arrived Old Mother Nature began the morning lesson.

"Happy Jack," said she, "you may tell us all you know about your cousin, Chatterer."

"To begin with, he is the smallest of the Tree Squirrels," said Happy Jack. "He isn't so very much bigger than Striped Chipmunk, and that means that he is less than half as big as myself. His coat is red and his waistcoat white; his tail is about two-thirds as long as his body and flat but not very broad. Personally, I don't think it is much of a tail."

At once Chatterer's quick temper flared up and he began to scold. But Old Mother Nature silenced him and told Happy Jack to go on. "He spends more of his time in the trees than I do," continued Happy Jack, "and is especially fond of pine trees and other cone-bearing trees. He likes the deeper parts of the Green Forest better than I do, though he seems to feel just as much at home on the edge of the Green Forest, especially if it is near a farm where he can steal corn."

Chatterer started to scold again but was silenced once more by Old Mother Nature. "I have to admit that Chatterer is thrifty," continued Happy Jack, quite as if he hadn't been interrupted. "He is very fond of the seeds of cone-bearing trees. He cuts the cones from the trees just before they are ripe. Then they ripen and open on the ground, where he can get at the seeds easily. He often has a number of store-houses and stores up cone seeds, acorns, nuts, and corn when he can get it. He builds a nest of leaves and strips of bark, sometimes in a hollow tree and sometimes high up in the branches of an evergreen tree. He is a good jumper and jumps from tree to tree. He is a busybody and always poking his nose in where he has no business. He steals my stores whenever he can find them."

"You do the same thing to me when you have the chance, which isn't often," sputtered Chatterer.

Happy Jack turned his back to Chatterer and continued, "He doesn't seem to mind cold weather at all, as long as the sun shines. His noisy tongue is to be heard on the coldest days of winter. He is the sauciest, most impudent fellow of the Green Forest, and never so happy as when he is making trouble for others. He sauces and scolds everybody he meets, and every time he opens his mouth he jerks his tail. He's quarrelsome. Worse than that, in the spring when the birds are nesting, he turns robber. He goes hunting for nests and steals the eggs, and what is even more dreadful, he kills and eats the baby birds. All the birds hate him, and I don't blame them."

Chatterer could contain himself no longer. His tongue fairly flew and he jerked his tail so hard and so fast that Peter Rabbit almost expected to see him break it right off. He called Happy Jack names, all the bad names he could think of, and worked himself up into such a rage that it was some time before Old Mother Nature could quiet him.

When at last he stopped from sheer lack of breath, Old Mother Nature spoke, and her voice was very severe. "I'm ashamed of you, Chatterer," said she. "Unfortunately, what Happy Jack has said about you is true. In many ways you are a disgrace to the Green Forest. Still I don't know how the Green Forest could get along without you. Happy Jack forgot to mention that you eat some insects at times. He also forgot to mention that sometimes you have a storehouse down in the ground. Now tell us what you know about your cousin, Happy Jack."

For a few minutes Chatterer sulked, but he did not dare disobey Old Mother Nature. "I don't know much good about him," he mumbled.

"And you don't know much bad about me either," retorted Happy Jack sharply.

Old Mother Nature held up a warning hand. "That will do," said she. "Now, Chatterer, go on."

"Happy Jack is more than twice as big as I, but at that, I'm not afraid of him," said Chatterer and glared at Happy Jack. "He is gray all over, except underneath, where he is white. He has a tremendously big tail and is so proud of it he shows it off whenever he has a chance. When he sits up he has a way of folding his hands on his breast. I don't know what he does it for unless it is to keep them warm in cold weather. He builds a nest very much like mine. Sometimes it is in a hollow tree, but quite as often it is in the branches of a tree. He is a good traveler in the tree-tops, but he spends a good deal of his time on the ground. He likes open woodland best, especially where there are many nut trees. He has a storehouse where he stores up nuts for winter, but he buries in the ground and under the leaves more than he puts in his storehouse. In winter, when he is hungry, he hunts for those buried nuts, and somehow he manages to find them even when they are covered with snow. When he comes to stealing he is not better than I am. I have seen him steal birds' eggs, and I wouldn't trust him unwatched around one of my storehouses."

It was Happy Jack's turn to become indignant. "I may have taken a few eggs when I accidentally ran across them," said he, "but I never go looking for them, and I don't take them unless I am very hungry and can't find anything else. I don't make a business of robbing birds the way you do, and you know it. If I find one of your storehouses and help myself, I am only getting back what you have stolen from me. Everybody loves me and that is more than you can say."

"That's enough," declared Old Mother Nature, and her voice was very sharp. "You two cousins never have agreed and I am afraid never will. As long as you are neighbors, I suspect you will quarrel. Have you told us all you know about Happy Jack, Chatterer?"

Chatterer nodded. He was still mumbling to himself angrily and wasn't polite enough to make a reply. Old Mother Nature took no notice of this. "What you have told us is good as far as it goes," said she. "You said that Happy Jack is all gray excepting underneath. Usually the Gray Squirrel is just as Chatterer has described him, but sometimes a Gray Squirrel isn't gray at all, but all black."

Peter Rabbit's ears stood straight up with astonishment. "How can a Gray Squirrel be black?" he demanded.

Old Mother Nature smiled. "That is a fair question, Peter," said she. "Gray Squirrel is simply the name of Happy Jack's family. Sometimes some of the babies are born with black coats instead of gray coats. Of course they are just the same kind of Squirrel, only they look different. In some parts of the country there are numbers of these black-coated Squirrels and many think they are a different kind of Squirrel. They are not. They are simply black-coated

members of Happy Jack's family. Just remember this. It is the same way in the family of Rusty the Fox Squirrel. Some members are rusty red, some are a mixture of red and gray, and some are as gray as Happy Jack himself. Way down in the Sunny South Fox Squirrels always have white noses and ears. In the North they never have white noses and ears. Rusty the Fox Squirrel is just a little bigger than Happy Jack and has just such a handsome tail. He is the strongest and heaviest of the Tree Squirrels and not nearly as quick and graceful as Happy Jack. Sometimes Rusty has two nests in the same tree, one in a hollow in a tree for bad weather and the other made of sticks and leaves outside in the branches for use in good weather. Rusty's habits are very much the same as those of Happy Jack the Gray Squirrel, and therefore he likes the same kind of surroundings. Like his cousin, Happy Jack, Rusty is a great help to me."

Seeing how surprised everybody looked, Mother Nature explained. "Both Happy Jack and Rusty bury a great many more nuts than they ever need," said she, "and those they do not dig up sprout in the spring and grow. In that way they plant ever so many trees without knowing it. Just remember that, Chatterer, the next time you are tempted to quarrel with your cousin, Happy Jack. Very likely Happy Jack's great-great-ever-so-great grandfather planted the very tree you get your fattest and best hickory nuts from.

"Way out in the mountains of the Far West you have a cousin called the Douglas Squirrel, who is really a true Red Squirrel and whose habits are very much like your own. Some folks call him the Pine Squirrel. By the way, Chatterer, Happy Jack forgot to say that you are a good swimmer. Perhaps he didn't know it."

By the expression of Happy Jack's face it was quite clear that he didn't know it. "Certainly I can swim," said Chatterer. "I don't mind the water at all. I can swim a long distance if I have to."

This was quite as much news to Peter Rabbit as had been the fact that a cousin of his own was a good swimmer, and he began to feel something very like respect for Chatterer.

"Are there any other Tree Squirrels?" asked Jumper the Hare.

"Yes," replied Old Mother Nature, "there are two--the handsomest of all the family. They live out in the Southwest, in one of the most wonderful places in all this great land, a place called the Grand Canyon. One is called the Abert Squirrel and the other the Kaibab Squirrel. They are about the size of Happy Jack and Rusty but have broader, handsomer tails and their ears have long tufts of hair. The Abert Squirrel has black ears, a brown back, gray sides and white underneath. Kaibab has brown ears with black tips, and his tail is mostly white. Both are very lovely, but their families are small and so they are little known."

With this, Old Mother Nature dismissed school for the day.

Stop here. Prefer one chapter. Ch. 6 only if the same sitting still has room and delight.

The Wind in the Willows · Chapter 4 · Mr. Badger (continued)

Kenneth Grahame. Project Gutenberg eBook #289. Public domain. Continues after Week 4's bedtime at Badger's.

MR. BADGER · NEXT MORNING

In accordance with the kindly Badger's injunctions, the two tired animals came down to breakfast very late next morning, and found a bright fire burning in the kitchen, and two young hedgehogs sitting on a bench at the table, eating oatmeal porridge out of wooden bowls. The hedgehogs dropped their spoons, rose to their feet, and ducked their heads respectfully as the two entered.

"There, sit down, sit down," said the Rat pleasantly, "and go on with your porridge. Where have you youngsters come from? Lost your way in the snow, I suppose?"

"Yes, please, sir," said the elder of the two hedgehogs respectfully. "Me and little Billy here, we was trying to find our way to school—mother _would_ have us go, was the weather ever so—and of course we lost ourselves, sir, and Billy he got frightened and took and cried, being young and faint-hearted. And at last we happened up against Mr. Badger's back door, and made so bold as to knock, sir, for Mr. Badger he's a kind-hearted gentleman, as everyone knows——"

"I understand," said the Rat, cutting himself some rashers from a side of bacon, while the Mole dropped some eggs into a saucepan. "And what's the weather like outside? You needn't 'sir' me quite so much?" he added.

"O, terrible bad, sir, terrible deep the snow is," said the hedgehog. "No getting out for the likes of you gentlemen to-day."

"Where's Mr. Badger?" inquired the Mole, as he warmed the coffee-pot before the fire.

"The master's gone into his study, sir," replied the hedgehog, "and he said as how he was going to be particular busy this morning, and on no account was he to be disturbed."

This explanation, of course, was thoroughly understood by every one present. The fact is, as already set forth, when you live a life of intense activity for six months in the year, and of comparative or actual somnolence for the other six, during the latter period you cannot be continually pleading sleepiness when there are people about or things to be done. The excuse gets monotonous. The animals well knew that Badger, having eaten a hearty breakfast, had retired to his study and settled himself in an arm-chair with his legs up on another and a red cotton handkerchief over his face, and was being "busy" in the usual way at this time of the year.

The front-door bell clanged loudly, and the Rat, who was very greasy with buttered toast, sent Billy, the smaller hedgehog, to see who it might be. There was a sound of much stamping in the hall, and presently Billy returned in front of the Otter, who threw himself on the Rat with an embrace and a shout of affectionate greeting.

"Get off!" spluttered the Rat, with his mouth full.

"Thought I should find you here all right," said the Otter cheerfully. "They were all in a great state of alarm along River Bank when I arrived this morning. Rat never been home all night—nor Mole either—something dreadful must have happened, they said; and the snow had covered up all your tracks, of course. But I knew that when people were in any fix they mostly went to Badger, or else Badger got to know of it somehow, so I came straight off here, through the Wild Wood and the snow! My! it was fine, coming through the snow as the red sun was rising and showing against the black tree-trunks! As you went along in the stillness, every now and then masses of snow slid off the branches suddenly with a flop! making you jump and run for cover. Snow-castles and snow-caverns had sprung up out of nowhere in the night—and snow bridges, terraces, ramparts—I could have stayed and played with them for hours. Here and there great branches had been torn away by the sheer weight of the snow, and robins perched and hopped on them in their perky conceited way, just as if they had done it themselves. A ragged string of wild geese

passed overhead, high on the grey sky, and a few rooks whirled over the trees, inspected, and flapped off homewards with a disgusted expression; but I met no sensible being to ask the news of. About halfway across I came on a rabbit sitting on a stump, cleaning his silly face with his paws. He was a pretty scared animal when I crept up behind him and placed a heavy forepaw on his shoulder. I had to cuff his head once or twice to get any sense out of it at all. At last I managed to extract from him that Mole had been seen in the Wild Wood last night by one of them. It was the talk of the burrows, he said, how Mole, Mr. Rat's particular friend, was in a bad fix; how he had lost his way, and 'They' were up and out hunting, and were chivvying him round and round. 'Then why didn't any of you _do_ something?' I asked. 'You mayn't be blest with brains, but there are hundreds and hundreds of you, big, stout fellows, as fat as butter, and your burrows running in all directions, and you could have taken him in and made him safe and comfortable, or tried to, at all events.' 'What, _us?_' he merely said: '_do_ something? us rabbits?' So I cuffed him again and left him. There was nothing else to be done. At any rate, I had learnt something; and if I had had the luck to meet any of 'Them' I'd have learnt something more—or _they_ would."

"Weren't you at all—er—nervous?" asked the Mole, some of yesterday's terror coming back to him at the mention of the Wild Wood.

"Nervous?" The Otter showed a gleaming set of strong white teeth as he laughed. "I'd give 'em nerves if any of them tried anything on with me. Here, Mole, fry me some slices of ham, like the good little chap you are. I'm frightfully hungry, and I've got any amount to say to Ratty here. Haven't seen him for an age."

So the good-natured Mole, having cut some slices of ham, set the hedgehogs to fry it, and returned to his own breakfast, while the Otter and the Rat, their heads together, eagerly talked river-shop, which is long shop and talk that is endless, running on like the babbling river itself.

A plate of fried ham had just been cleared and sent back for more, when the Badger entered, yawning and rubbing his eyes, and greeted them all in his quiet, simple way, with kind enquiries for every one. "It must be getting on for luncheon time," he remarked to the Otter. "Better stop and have it with us. You must be hungry, this cold morning."

"Rather!" replied the Otter, winking at the Mole. "The sight of these greedy young hedgehogs stuffing themselves with fried ham makes me feel positively famished."

The hedgehogs, who were just beginning to feel hungry again after their porridge, and after working so hard at their frying, looked timidly up at Mr. Badger, but were too shy to say anything.

"Here, you two youngsters be off home to your mother," said the Badger kindly. "I'll send some one with you to show you the way. You won't want any dinner to-day, I'll be bound."

He gave them sixpence apiece and a pat on the head, and they went off with much respectful swinging of caps and touching of forelocks.

Presently they all sat down to luncheon together. The Mole found himself placed next to Mr. Badger, and, as the other two were still deep in river-gossip from which nothing could divert them, he took the opportunity to tell Badger how comfortable and home-like it all felt to him. "Once well underground," he said, "you know exactly where you are. Nothing can happen to you, and nothing can get at you. You're entirely your own master, and you don't have to consult anybody or mind what they say. Things go on all the same overhead, and you let 'em, and don't bother about 'em. When you want to, up you go, and there the things are, waiting for you."

The Badger simply beamed on him. "That's exactly what I say," he replied. "There's no security, or peace and tranquillity, except underground. And then, if your ideas get larger and you want to expand—why, a dig and a scrape, and there you are! If you feel your house is a bit too big, you stop up a hole or two, and there you are again! No builders, no tradesmen, no remarks passed on you by fellows looking over your wall, and, above all, no _weather_. Look at Rat, now. A couple of feet of flood water, and he's got to move into hired lodgings; uncomfortable, inconveniently situated, and horribly expensive. Take Toad. I say nothing against Toad Hall; quite the best house in these parts, _as_ a house. But supposing a fire breaks out—where's Toad? Supposing tiles are blown off, or walls

sink or crack, or windows get broken—where’s Toad? Supposing the rooms are draughty—I _hate_ a draught myself—where’s Toad? No, up and out of doors is good enough to roam about and get one’s living in; but underground to come back to at last—that’s my idea of _home!_”

The Mole assented heartily; and the Badger in consequence got very friendly with him. “When lunch is over,” he said, “I’ll take you all round this little place of mine. I can see you’ll appreciate it. You understand what domestic architecture ought to be, you do.”

Time cap. Stop at twenty minutes or at the printed end. The rest of Badger’s house (and Dulce Domum) wait.

Grimm's Fairy Tales · one gentle tale

From your physical book · never reprinted in this packet

Open your Pantheon Complete Grimm's.

Choose one short gentle tale by title — “The Golden Goose,” “Mother Holle,” or “The Queen Bee.” Read once. Narrate. Then stop.

Never reprint Pantheon text in a packet.

DAY FOUR · BOTH CHILDREN AT 8:00

OCTOBER 10, 2026

Saturday

HAVE READY

Bible · folk or hymn · Ray's (Lesson 12) · Understood Betsy ch. 4 · Harvey's · Pilgrim's Progress sitting · nature notebook · evening walk plan

8:00	Nature sit or save for evening Short morning sit, or keep powder dry for a Saturday evening Lost Pines walk after the heat drops.
8:20	Bible · Luke 20:9–18 Open your ESV to Luke 20:9–18. Parable of the Tenants. Read once. Narrate. No Awana.
8:35	Folk song, Ray's, copywork, recitation Bold Grenadier or hymn stanza. Lesson 12 (last Ray's of the week). Copywork line. Genesis 1:1 from their ESV.
9:05	Literature · Understood Betsy ch. 4 “Betsy Goes to School.” Printed. Cap 20 minutes even mid-chapter. Narrate what school is like now.
9:30	Harvey's · ~10 min Continue from Thursday's place. Light and oral.
9:45	Pilgrim's Progress ~700 words printed: Help at the Slough, then the road and Worldly Wiseman's greeting. Stop where the packet stops.
10:05	Composer or Willows leftover

Bernstein *Jeremiah* five to eight minutes while they draw in the nature notebook — or finish a Willows bookmark if Friday needed it.

evening **Lost Pines walk** **PRESCHOOLER JOINS**

After 6pm heat drop. One invertebrate, one bird, or one pine/creek note. Watch for fire ants. Notebook: draw, date, scribe one sentence.

How to teach Saturday

No Awana. Keep Betsy capped. Evening walk still counts as school when the morning frays.

Luke 20:9–18

Parable of the Tenants. Short. Narrate what the tenants did and what the owner did.

Understood Betsy

Chapter 4 may run long in print — protect the twenty-minute cap. A second short sitting next week beats a tired child.

Pilgrim's Progress

Help draws Christian out; the Slough is explained; Worldly Wiseman begins to speak. Stop at the printed end.

When the week is done

Shelf books stayed inside the same morning — no second school day. Island Story returns ~Week 6. Seabird still waits for ~Week 19.

Bible · Luke 20:9–18

ESV · open your physical copy · never reprint verse text

Open your ESV to Luke 20:9–18.

Read once. Close the Bible. Narrate. Then stop.

Do not print or paste ESV (or any modern) Bible text — use the physical book only.

Parable of the Tenants. Both children may listen.

Understood Betsy · Chapter 4 · Betsy Goes to School

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CHAPTER IV

BETSY GOES TO SCHOOL

Elizabeth Ann was very much surprised to hear Cousin Ann's voice calling, "Dinner!" down the stairs. It did not seem possible that the whole morning had gone by. "Here," said Aunt Abigail, "just put that pat on a plate, will you, and take it upstairs as you go. I've got all I can do to haul my own two hundred pounds up, without any half-pound of butter into the bargain." The little girl smiled at this, though she did not exactly know why, and skipped up the stairs proudly with her butter.

Dinner was smoking on the table, which was set in the midst of the great pool of sunlight. A very large black-and-white dog, with a great bushy tail, was walking around and around the table, sniffing the air. He looked as big as a bear to Elizabeth Ann; and as he walked his great red tongue hung out of his mouth and his white teeth gleamed horribly. Elizabeth Ann shrank back in terror, clutching her plate of butter to her breast with tense fingers. Cousin Ann said, over her shoulder: "Oh, bother! There's old Shep, got up to pester us begging for scraps! Shep! You go and lie down this minute!" To Elizabeth Ann's astonishment and immense relief, the great animal turned, drooping his head sadly, walked back across the floor, got upon the couch again, and laid his head down on one paw very forlornly, turning up the whites of his eyes meekly at Cousin Ann.

Aunt Abigail, who had just pulled herself up the stairs, panting, said, between laughing and puffing: "I'm glad I'm not an animal on this farm. Ann does boss them around so." "Well, **SOME**body has to!" said Cousin Ann, advancing on the table with a platter. This proved to have chicken fricassee on it, and Elizabeth Ann's heart melted in her at the smell. She loved chicken gravy on hot biscuits beyond anything in the world, but chickens are so expensive when you buy them in the market that Aunt Harriet hadn't had them very often for dinner. And there was a plate of biscuits, golden brown, just coming out of the oven! She sat down very quickly, her mouth watering, and attacked with extreme haste the big plateful of food which Cousin Ann passed her.

At Aunt Harriet's she had always been aware that everybody watched her anxiously as she ate, and she had heard so much about her light appetite that she felt she must live up to her reputation, and had a very natural and human hesitation about eating all she wanted when there happened to be something she liked very much. But nobody here knew that she "only ate enough to keep a bird alive," and that her "appetite was **SO** capricious!" Nor did anybody notice her while she stowed away the chicken and gravy and hot biscuits and currant jelly and baked potatoes and apple pie—when did Elizabeth Ann ever eat such a meal before! She actually felt her belt grow tight.

In the middle of the meal Cousin Ann got up to answer the telephone, which was in the next room. The instant the door had closed behind her Uncle Henry leaned forward, tapped Elizabeth Ann on the shoulder, and nodded toward the sofa. His eyes were twinkling, and as for Aunt Abigail she began to laugh silently, shaking all over, her napkin at her mouth to stifle the sound. Elizabeth Ann turned wonderingly and saw the old dog cautiously and noiselessly letting himself down from the sofa, one ear cocked rigidly in the direction of Cousin Ann's voice in the next room. "The old tyke!" said Uncle Henry. "He always sneaks up to the table to be fed if Ann goes out for a minute. Here, Betsy, you're nearest, give him this piece of skin from the chicken neck." The big dog padded forward across the room, evidently in such a state of terror about Cousin Ann that Elizabeth Ann felt for him. She had a fellow-feeling about that relative of hers. Also it was impossible to be afraid of so abjectly meek and guilty an animal. As old Shep came up to her, poking his nose inquiringly on her lap, she shrinkingly held out the big piece of skin, and though she jumped back at the sudden snap and gobbling gulp with which the old dog greeted the tidbit, she could not but sympathize with his evident enjoyment of it. He waved his bushy tail gratefully, cocked his head on one side, and, his

ears standing up at attention, his eyes glistening greedily, he gave a little, begging whine. “Oh, he’s asking for more!” cried Elizabeth Ann, surprised to see how plainly she could understand dog-talk. “Quick, Uncle Henry, give me another piece!”

Uncle Henry rapidly transferred to her plate a wing-bone from his own, and Aunt Abigail, with one deft swoop, contributed the neck from the platter. As fast as she could, Elizabeth Ann fed these to Shep, who woofed them down at top speed, the bones crunching loudly under his strong, white teeth. How he did enjoy it! It did your heart good to see his gusto!

[Illustration: “Oh, he’s asking for more” cried Elizabeth Ann]

There was the sound of the telephone receiver being hung up in the next room—and everybody acted at once. Aunt Abigail began drinking innocently out of her coffee-cup, only her laughing old eyes showing over the rim; Uncle Henry buttered a slice of bread with a grave face, as though he were deep in conjectures about who would be the next President; and as for old Shep, he made one plunge across the room, his toe-nails clicking rapidly on the bare floor, sprang up on the couch, and when Cousin Ann opened the door and came in he was lying in exactly the position in which she had left him, his paw stretched out, his head laid on it, his brown eyes turned up meekly so that the whites showed.

I’ve told you what these three did, but I haven’t told you yet what Elizabeth Ann did. And it is worth telling. As Cousin Ann stepped in, glancing suspiciously from her sober-faced and abstracted parents to the lamb-like innocence of old Shep, little Elizabeth Ann burst into a shout of laughter. It’s worth telling about, because, so far as I know, that was the first time she had ever laughed out heartily in all her life. For my part, I’m half surprised to know that she knew how.

Of course, when she laughed, Aunt Abigail had to laugh too, setting down her coffee-cup and showing all the funny wrinkles in her face screwed up hard with fun; and that made Uncle Henry laugh, and then Cousin Ann laughed and said, as she sat down, “You are bad children, the whole four of you!” And old Shep, seeing the state of things, stopped pretending to be meek, jumped down, and came lumbering over to the table, wagging his tail and laughing too; you know that good, wide dog-smile! He put his head on Elizabeth Ann’s lap again and she patted it and lifted up one of his big black ears. She had quite forgotten that she was terribly afraid of big dogs.

After dinner Cousin Ann looked up at the clock and said: “My goodness! Betsy’ll be late for school if she doesn’t start right off.” She explained to the child, aghast at this sudden thunderclap, “I let you sleep this morning as long as you wanted to, because you were so tired from your journey. But of course there’s no reason for missing the afternoon session.”

As Elizabeth Ann continued sitting perfectly still, frozen with alarm, Cousin Ann jumped up briskly, got the little coat and cap, helped her up, and began inserting the child’s arms into the sleeves. She pulled the cap well down over Elizabeth Ann’s ears, felt in the pocket and pulled out the mittens. “There,” she said, holding them out, “you’d better put them on before you go out, for it’s a real cold day.” As she led the stupefied little girl along toward the door Aunt Abigail came after them and put a big sugar-cookie into the child’s hand. “Maybe you’ll like to eat that for your recess time,” she said. “I always did when I went to school.”

Elizabeth Ann’s hand closed automatically about the cookie, but she scarcely heard what was said. She felt herself to be in a bad dream. Aunt Frances had never, no NEVER, let her go to school alone, and on the first day of the year always took her to the new teacher and introduced her and told the teacher how sensitive she was and how hard to understand; and then she stayed there for an hour or two till Elizabeth Ann got used to things! She could not face a whole new school all alone—oh, she couldn’t, she wouldn’t! She couldn’t! Horrors! Here she was in the front hall—she was on the porch! Cousin Ann was saying: “Now run along, child. Straight down the road till the first turn to the left, and there in the cross-roads, there you are.” And now the front door closed behind her, the path stretched before her to the road, and the road led down the hill the way Cousin Ann had pointed. Elizabeth Ann’s feet began to move forward and carried her down the path, although she was still crying out to herself, “I can’t! I won’t! I can’t!”

Are you wondering why Elizabeth Ann didn't turn right around, open the front door, walk in, and say, "I can't! I won't! I can't!" to Cousin Ann?

The answer to that question is that she didn't do it because Cousin Ann was Cousin Ann. And there's more in that than you think! In fact, there is a mystery in it that nobody has ever solved, not even the greatest scientists and philosophers, although, like all scientists and philosophers, they think they have gone a long way toward explaining something they don't understand by calling it a long name. The long name is "personality," and what it means nobody knows, but it is perhaps the very most important thing in the world for all that. And yet we know only one or two things about it. We know that anybody's personality is made up of the sum total of all the actions and thoughts and desires of his life. And we know that though there aren't any words or any figures in any language to set down that sum total accurately, still it is one of the first things that everybody knows about anybody else. And that is really all we know!

So I can't tell you why Elizabeth Ann did not go back and cry and sob and say she couldn't and she wouldn't and she couldn't, as she would certainly have done at Aunt Harriet's. You remember that I could not even tell you why it was that, as the little fatherless and motherless girl lay in bed looking at Aunt Abigail's old face, she should feel so comforted and protected that she must needs break out crying. No, all I can say is that it was because Aunt Abigail was Aunt Abigail. But perhaps it may occur to you that it's rather a good idea to keep a sharp eye on your "personality," whatever that is! It might be very handy, you know, to have a personality like Cousin Ann's which sent Elizabeth Ann's feet down the path; or perhaps you would prefer one like Aunt Abigail's. Well, take your choice.

You must not, of course, think for a moment that Elizabeth Ann had the slightest INTENTION of obeying Cousin Ann. No indeed! Nothing was farther from her mind as her feet carried her along the path and into the road. In her mind was nothing but rebellion and fear and anger and oh, such hurt feelings! She turned sick at the very thought of facing all the staring, curious faces in the playground turned on the new scholar as she had seen them at home! She would never, never do it! She would walk around all the afternoon, and then go back and tell Cousin Ann that she couldn't! She would EXPLAIN to her how Aunt Frances never let her go out of doors without a loving hand to cling to. She would EXPLAIN to her how Aunt Frances always took care of her! ... it was easier to think about what she would say and do and explain, away from Cousin Ann, than it was to say and do it before those black eyes. Aunt Frances's eyes were soft, light blue.

Oh, how she wanted Aunt Frances to take care of her! Nobody cared a thing about her! Nobody UNDERSTOOD her but Aunt Frances! She wouldn't go back at all to Putney Farm. She would just walk on and on till she was lost, and the night would come and she would lie down and freeze to death, and then wouldn't Cousin Ann feel ... Someone called to her, "Isn't this Betsy?"

She looked up astonished. A young girl in a gingham dress and a white apron like those at Putney Farm stood in front of a tiny, square building, like a toy house. "Isn't this Betsy?" asked the young girl again. "Your Cousin Ann said you were coming to school today and I've been looking out for you. But I saw you going right by, and I ran out to stop you."

"Why, where IS the school?" asked Betsy, staring around for a big brick, four-story building.

The young girl laughed and held out her hand. "This is the school," she said, "and I am the teacher, and you'd better come right in, for it's time to begin."

She led Betsy into a low-ceilinged room with geraniums at the windows, where about a dozen children of different ages sat behind their desks. At the first sight of them Betsy blushed crimson with fright and shyness, and hung down her head; but, looking out the corners of her eyes, she saw that they, too, were all very red-faced and scared-looking and hung down their heads, looking at her shyly out of the corners of their eyes. She was so surprised by this that she forgot all about herself and looked inquiringly at the teacher.

"They don't see many strangers," the teacher explained, "and they feel very shy and scared when a new scholar comes, especially one from the city."

"Is this my grade?" asked Elizabeth, thinking it the very smallest grade she had ever seen.

“This is the whole school,” said the teacher. “There are only two or three in each class. You’ll probably have three in yours. Miss Ann said you were in the third grade. There, that’s your seat.”

Elizabeth sat down before a very old desk, much battered and hacked up with knife marks. There was a big H. P. carved just over the inkwell, and many other initials scattered all over the top.

The teacher stepped back to her desk and took up a violin that lay there. “Now, children, we’ll begin the afternoon session by singing ‘America,’” she said. She played the air over a little very sweetly and stirringly, and then as the children stood up she came down close to them, standing just in front of Betsy. She drew the bow across the strings in a big chord, and said, “NOW,” and Betsy burst into song with the others. The sun came in the windows brightly, the teacher, too, sang as she played, and all the children, even the littlest ones, opened their mouths wide and sang lustily.

Time cap. Stop at twenty minutes even mid-chapter. A second short sitting is better than a tired child.

The Pilgrim's Progress · Help at the Slough, and the road

John Bunyan. Project Gutenberg eBook #131. Public domain. Continues after Week 4's fall into the Slough.

HELP. But why did not you look for the steps?

CHR. Fear followed me so hard, that I fled the next way, and fell in.

HELP. Then said he, Give me thy hand: so he gave him his hand, and he drew him out, and set him upon sound ground, and bid him go on his way. [Ps. 40:2]

Then I stepped to him that plucked him out, and said, Sir, wherefore, since over this place is the way from the City of Destruction to yonder gate, is it that this plat is not mended, that poor travellers might go thither with more security? And he said unto me, This miry slough is such a place as cannot be mended; it is the descent whither the scum and filth that attends conviction for sin doth continually run, and therefore it is called the Slough of Despond; for still, as the sinner is awakened about his lost condition, there ariseth in his soul many fears, and doubts, and discouraging apprehensions, which all of them get together, and settle in this place. And this is the reason of the badness of this ground.

It is not the pleasure of the King that this place should remain so bad. [Isa. 35:3,4] His labourers also have, by the direction of His Majesty's surveyors, been for above these sixteen hundred years employed about this patch of ground, if perhaps it might have been mended: yea, and to my knowledge, said he, here have been swallowed up at least twenty thousand cart-loads, yea, millions of wholesome instructions, that have at all seasons been brought from all places of the King's dominions, and they that can tell, say they are the best materials to make good ground of the place; if so be, it might have been mended, but it is the Slough of Despond still, and so will be when they have done what they can.

True, there are, by the direction of the Law-giver, certain good and substantial steps, placed even through the very midst of this slough; but at such time as this place doth much spew out its filth, as it doth against change of weather, these steps are hardly seen; or, if they be, men, through the dizziness of their heads, step beside, and then they are bemired to purpose, notwithstanding the steps be there; but the ground is good when they are once got in at the gate. [1 Sam. 12:23]

Now, I saw in my dream, that by this time Pliable was got home to his house again, so that his neighbours came to visit him; and some of them called him wise man for coming back, and some called him fool for hazarding himself with Christian: others again did mock at his cowardliness; saying, Surely, since you began to venture, I would not have been so base to have given out for a few difficulties. So Pliable sat sneaking among them. But at last he got more confidence, and then they all turned their tales, and began to deride poor Christian behind his back. And thus much concerning Pliable.

Now, as Christian was walking solitarily by himself, he espied one afar off, come crossing over the field to meet him; and their hap was to meet just as they were crossing the way of each other. The gentleman's name that met him was Mr. Worldly Wiseman, he dwelt in the town of Carnal Policy, a very great town, and also hard by from whence Christian came. This man, then, meeting with Christian, and having some inkling of him,--for Christian's setting forth from the City of Destruction was much noised abroad, not only in the town where he dwelt, but also it began to be the town talk in some other places,--Mr. Worldly Wiseman, therefore, having some guess of him, by beholding his laborious going, by observing his sighs and groans, and the like, began thus to enter into some talk with Christian.

WORLD. How now, good fellow, whither away after this burdened manner?

CHR. A burdened manner, indeed, as ever, I think, poor creature had! And whereas you ask me, Whither away? I tell you, Sir, I am going to yonder wicket-gate before me; for there, as I am informed, I shall be put into a way to be rid of my heavy burden.

Stop here. Worldly Wiseman's longer counsel waits for another week.

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